MICHAEL CASEY

Product Designer

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Creative solution provider with product design, product management, software development and business management experience. Over 11 years as Principal Product Designer specializing in complex fintech applications for Enterprise and B2B2C applications. I collaborate closely with product owners, developers, and cross-functional teams. Organized a UX community of practice at ION, advocating for design system adoption across product teams, and leading UX improvement initiatives across the Corporates portfolio. In 2026, completed a self-initiated, four-project series using AI to speed up product work, taking one proposed Vanguard rebalancing tool from design to a deployed app with AI features of its own. Then built Sterling, a design system of tokens, a Figma library and React components in Storybook, with Claude Code under my direction.

WORK HISTORY

Principal Product Designer – ION Group

Jan 2014 – Nov 2025 | Horsham, Pennsylvania

- Principal product designer for concept to completion of Enterprise & B2B2C products
- Delivered designs for all elements of 0-1 project for agribusiness trading and risk management, which includes 10 dashboards made up of more than 25 business components
- Organized and led product team planning to clarify problems and pain points through product advisory board sessions with users, interviews with subject matter experts, and comparative analysis of other products
- Created Personas and conducted Day-in-the-Life-Of planning to inform user-centered design decisions for complex workflows and streamlined decision-making dashboards
- Performed iterative process of sketching concepts, progressively maturing from wireframes to higher fidelity designs, and periodic presentations of progress to senior management
- Leveraged Figma to design components, apply Design System tokens for consistency/brand themes, and publish prototypes for gathering feedback
- Contributed to Design System planning of components and patterns
- Collaborated with stakeholders and cross-functional teams to maximize attention to Interaction Design principles, while considering technical and resource constraints within a matrixed component development organization
- Applied lean & agile practices to incrementally plan progressive designs for efficiency and fast learning
- Guided product design decisions on complex data grid features for data-dense decision support displays: virtual scrolling, progressive disclosure, real-time updates, and inline grid editing
- Applied usability testing feedback to improve user satisfaction by 27%
- Researched and tested color contrasts for meeting WCAG 2.1 AA accessibility standards
- Analyzed integration with IoT devices to allow user experience to blend manual and automated data capture for variable operational workflows
- Organized heuristic evaluations of usability characteristics across 9 products
- Planned SaaS admin dashboard and onboarding user experience for customer tenants
- Automated gathering of metrics from end user activity for analysis of usage and prioritizing work
- Collaborated with scrum teams to develop stories and backlog refinements in JIRA
- Communicated complex concepts to both technical and non-technical audiences
- Served as UX thought leader by establishing a UX community of practice group across multiple products

Lean & Agile Coach – ION Group

Jan 2013 – Jan 2014 | Horsham, Pennsylvania

- Led the reorganization of workflow for Financial Software Systems while acting as Agile coach for newly formed Scrum teams
- Designed and managed implementation of Kanban management system for Financial Software Systems

- Reduced cycle-time throughput of support issues by 21% and reduced backlog by 34%
- Scrum Master for multiple product teams practicing large-scale scrum across different time zones

Financial Software Systems, Inc. – *Horsham, Pennsylvania*

Held several pivotal leadership positions in building Financial Software Systems, steering its growth from an early-stage startup through to a successful acquisition by ION Group.

Senior Vice-President – Financial Software Systems, Inc.

2008 – 2012 (acquired by ION Dec 2012) | Horsham, Pennsylvania

- Established IT group to support 150+ employees
- Established Hosting Business to support sales of Software as a Service
- Tracked project costs, schedules and performance metrics for hosting business

Vice-President – Financial Software Systems, Inc.

2000 – 2008 | Horsham, Pennsylvania

- Lead System Architect and manager for R&D group to replace legacy desktop application with redesigned user interface on Microsoft .NET platform
- Established web development team to implement client portals, enhancing competitive advantage and facilitating growth — significantly contributed to positioning the business for a successful sale
- Developed desktop and web applications with C# .NET, ASP.NET, DevExpress, and Telerik components
- Attention to globalization and adapting to localized regions to support global sales

Product Manager – Financial Software Systems, Inc.

1997 – 2000 | Horsham, Pennsylvania

- Managed all aspects of product during early growth: financial research, software development, quality assurance, release management, documentation, and recruiting

Software Engineer – Financial Software Systems, Inc.

1996 – 1997 | Horsham, Pennsylvania

- Designed and implemented the Portfolio Analysis component, recognized as the application's key competitive advantage

PERSONAL PROJECTS

Sterling Design System

Self-initiated | Oct 2026

Designed and built a design system end to end with Claude Code under my direction: design tokens with Light/Dark and three density modes, a generated Figma library of 24 components and 20 icons, and matching React components in Storybook, all from one set of definitions. Automated checks for contrast, design–code parity, accessibility and token-only CSS run on every build. Portfolio | Storybook | GitHub

AI-Enabled (Narration & Assistance)

Self-initiated | Aug 2026 – Sep 2026

Extended an existing, deployed Vanguard Sell & Rebalance application with two AI-enabled end-user features: a narration layer that explains computed recommendations in language adapted across four researched investor mindsets, and a natural-language Scenario assistant that converts plain-language requests into structured, human-confirmed transactions. Every stated figure is sourced from the underlying deterministic optimization engine; AI explains and assists but never computes or executes financial actions directly. Replaced the prior project's phase-gated PM/PD/Dev handoff model with two continuously-updated context files, eliminating artifact handoffs between roles. Verification spanned mocked and live multi-provider testing (Claude, Groq, Gemini), surfacing and fixing a rare model-response leakage defect and several data-consistency bugs before production deployment. Case Study | Live Application

AI-Assisted Pipeline (0 to 1 Product Delivery)

Self-initiated | Apr 2026 – Jul 2026

A self-directed project executing the full product pipeline across three roles — Product Management, Product Design, and Development — applied to a hypothetical Vanguard Sell & Rebalance tool. Produced a complete artifact trail: PRD with 11 functional

requirements, 80-issue Jira backlog created via Atlassian Rovo MCP, canonical dataset (43 lots across 3 account types), 33-component Figma component library reverse-engineered from Vanguard's public screens, 12 annotated screens, a 50-connection wired Figma prototype, and a deployed React web application with a real dual-objective tax optimization engine (58/58 unit tests passing). Demonstrates cross-functional breadth across PM, UX, and full-stack development disciplines, with AI tools (Claude AI, Claude Code, Notion MCP, Figma MCP, ChatGPT, Gemini) applied systematically at every stage. Case Study | Live Application

AI-Assisted Development (Live Application)

Self-initiated | Mar 2026

Full-stack development project using AI-assisted coding to build a working prototype of the Vanguard Personal Investor Tool. Built with Next.js frontend and FastAPI backend, using Claude Code to accelerate development while maintaining code quality. Demonstrates autonomous build capability via Claude Code with Figma MCP integration. Case Study | Live Application

AI-Assisted Product Design (Prototypes)

Self-initiated | Feb 2026

An end-to-end AI-assisted design experiment examining how AI can accelerate the product design process without sacrificing design quality. Focus is a real feature concept for the Vanguard Personal Investor portal. Built across four structured design sessions using Claude and Figma, producing a detailed case study documenting the full process. Case Study

Agribusiness Trading & Risk Management — Case Study

Principal Product Designer | Dec 2024 – Jan 2025

Case study of sample project from work at ION Group. Includes analysis of full product scope and detailed planning of Logistics module. View Case Study

EDUCATION

M.B.A. Finance – Temple University

B.S. Computer Science – University of Pittsburgh

CERTIFICATIONS & TRAINING

- UX Designer — Nielsen Norman Group (ID: 1050997)
- Atlassian Agile Project Management
- Scrum — Craig Larman on-site training (Lean Thinking and Large-Scale Scrum)
- AWS Certified Practitioner (ID: UC-OKJIU899)
- Microsoft .NET
- Network Administration

SKILLS

Design & UX — Expert

UX/UI Design, User Interface Prototyping, User Experience Testing, User Empathy, Data-Rich Design, Responsive Web Applications, Design Systems

Design Tools — Expert (Figma) / Proficient (others)

Figma Design, FigJam, Slides & Make (Expert); UX Pin (Advanced); Adobe Creative Suite (Intermediate); Visio (Proficient)

Product & Agile Leadership — Expert

Agile Methodologies, Scrum, Roadmap Prioritization, User Stories, Business Analysis, Cross-Functional Communication, Strategic Thinking, JIRA

AI-Assisted Design & Development — Advanced

Claude AI, Claude Code, Notion, AI-Assisted Prototyping, AI Design & Development Workflows

Technical & Engineering — Proficient

Software Engineering, Data Modeling, Object-Oriented Programming, Test-Driven Development, C# .NET Programming, JavaScript, HTML, MS SQL, Power BI, Visual Studio, IntelliJ, Microsoft Office Suite, Microsoft Excel VBA, Google Workspace

VOLUNTEERING

School Board Director – Upper Moreland School District | Dec 2003 – Dec 2007

Treasurer – St. David, CYO | Jan 2008 – Nov 2010

WEB LINKS

Project Portfolio

Projects Timeline: https://etch-chief-15924551.figma.site/

LinkedIn Profile

Career Profile: https://www.linkedin.com/in/michael-casey-82551913/

Recommendations: https://www.linkedin.com/in/michael-casey-82551913/details/recommendations/

Sterling Design System

Sterling Portfolio: https://etch-chief-15924551.figma.site/sterling

Sterling Storybook: https://mcasey10.github.io/sterling-design-system/storybook/

Sterling GitHub: https://github.com/mcasey10/sterling-design-system

AI-Assisted Projects

AI Pipeline Summary: https://etch-chief-15924551.figma.site/ai-pipeline

AI Pipeline Live Application: https://vanguard-ai-pipeline-jade.vercel.app/

AI Pipeline by Role Document: https://mcasey10.github.io/vanguard-ai-pipeline/ai_pipeline.html

AI-Enabled Live Application: https://vanguard-ai-enabled.vercel.app/

AI-Enabled Progress Tracker: https://mcasey10.github.io/vanguard-ai-enabled/docs/progress.html

AI-Enabled GitHub: https://github.com/mcasey10/vanguard-ai-enabled

AI Dev Summary: https://etch-chief-15924551.figma.site/ai-project-dev

AI Dev Live Application: https://vanguard-rebalance-cc-v4.vercel.app/

AI Design Summary: https://etch-chief-15924551.figma.site/ai-project

Detailed Case Studies

AI Pipeline Case Study: https://etch-chief-15924551.figma.site/ai-pipeline

AI Dev Case Study: https://etch-chief-15924551.figma.site/ai-project-dev

AI Design Case Study: https://etch-chief-15924551.figma.site/ai-project

AI-Enabled Case Study: https://etch-chief-15924551.figma.site/ai-enabled

Agribusiness Trading & Risk Management: https://www.figma.com/deck/VQUMaUXdXygr72kjCpqtXa/Agribusiness-product-design?node-id=73-4862&t=QUvQRXEoQqxpEHxx-1

Product Websites (ION Group)

Agtech SaaS — Commodity Trading and Risk Management: https://iongroup.com/products/commodities/agtech/

TriplePoint — Commodity Trading and Risk Management: https://iongroup.com/products/commodities/triplepoint/

FEA Analyzer for Trading and Risk Analytics: https://iongroup.com/press-release/commodities/ion-commodities-advances-trading-and-risk-analytics-with-new-fea-analyzer/

Softmar — Vessel Chartering and Operations Management: https://iongroup.com/products/commodities/softmar/

Spectrum — FX Operations, Trading and Risk Management: https://iongroup.com/products/markets/spectrum/